

LITEON Technology

IT AI Platform Lead

Interview Dossier and Professional Background

From Applications to Products to a Reusable AI Platform

Move AI from point solutions to a reusable enterprise platform that complements SAP/PLM/MES, with economic value the executive team can see.

+15%	+18%	−25%	−30%
Product yield Hongyan Technology | AI defect prediction	**OEE** Hongyan Technology | Edge AIoT	**IT operating cost** Hongyan Technology | System consolidation	**Multi-cloud TCO** GameSparcs (6542) | FinOps

Candidate	Dr. Howard Liao
Current role	Sheng Xin / Sheng Qi Network VP of Technology/CIO (2025.05 – present)
Position applied for	LITEON Technology IT AI Platform Lead | Neihu, Taipei
Audience	Chairman, CIO, technical advisor, CHRO
Contact	+886-975-323161 · Liao.Howard@gmail.com
Version	V3.0 · November 2026 · 20 pages

How to read this report

This report follows the six responsibilities and three mandatory requirements in LITEON's job description; each item maps to track record, work samples and an onboarding plan.Advisory clients are not named for confidentiality; details can be discussed in person.

Six responsibilities in the job description × pages in this report

#	Responsibility	My corresponding focus	Pages
01	Define priority AI domains with senior leadership and plan the AI platform blueprint	Within 90 days, an AI value map and financial assumptions for the top 5 use cases	p.15–17
02	Turn scattered applications into reusable data products and platforms	New use cases go live in weeks instead of months	p.14–15
03	Build an AI stack that complements SAP, PLM and MES	First supply-chain AI use cases live within 6 months of the S/4HANA go-live	p.15–16
04	Build the AI organization and talent pipeline; lead AI technical leads and engineers	At least one ready successor for every technical lead	p.18
05	Build business-led platform teams and develop internal POs to drive AI-native ways of working	30 certified POs in year one	p.18
06	Report results regularly to senior leadership and business unit heads	Benefits reviewed openly every quarter, amounts confirmed by the CFO	p.20

Mandatory requirements × evidence

Requirement	My evidence
No restriction on education or industry background	Ph.D. in IT Management; electronics manufacturing, global software vendors and listed platforms
10+ years leading AI/data teams	CIO leading data and systems teams since 2010; AIoT and AI yield teams since 2018; Agentic AI team since 2025 — 15+ years in total
Led AI platform or product launches with quantifiable results	AI defect prediction: yield +15%, OEE +18%; Agentic AI: automation efficiency +55%

Preferred requirements

Requirement	My evidence
Built AI/data platforms and teams from scratch	Hongyan Technology Edge AIoT data hub and Sheng Xin / Sheng Qi Network AI governance and agent platform, both built from scratch
Communicating with the C-level and senior leadership	Reports directly to the Board and Global CIO; reports in EBITDA, TCO and ROIC
CIO or IT department head experience	15+ years as CIO/CISO/CDAIO/Director of IT
Digital transformation at large domestic enterprises	Multi-plant S/4HANA consolidation, zero-downtime migration of global core services, group central IT architecture

Executive summary

The conclusion in one sentence

LITEON needs a leader who can turn AI into a platform and show the Chairman the money. I have done three things: connected SAP, MES and PLM data in manufacturing to power AI; turned fragmented systems into platforms with zero downtime; and built ISO 42001 AI governance to put agents into production.



Figure 1 Eight quantified outcomes

LITEON's needs	My fit	My commitment
AI share of revenue above 30% in 2026, estimated 40–50% in 2027	Multi-plant consolidation: data silos → shared data hub, IT operating cost −25%	Within 90 days, an AI value map and financial assumptions for the top 5 use cases
S/4HANA global go-live on 2027.01.04	SAP Clean Core: custom objects −35%	AI extension layer leaves the core untouched, integrating via APIs/events
From point applications to a reusable platform	Three-tier enterprise AI platform; Agentic AI +55%	Platform MVP live in Q2
Business-led, AI-native ways of working	AI workflow training for managers, ISO 42001	30 certified POs in year one

Insights on LITEON today

NT$57.4B	15.1%	>30%	NT$19.7B
2026 Q3 revenue	**Q3 operating margin**	**2026 AI share of revenue**	**2026 capital expenditure**
Up 28% year on year	Operating income up 85% year on year	2027 estimated 40–50%	Raised from NT$18B

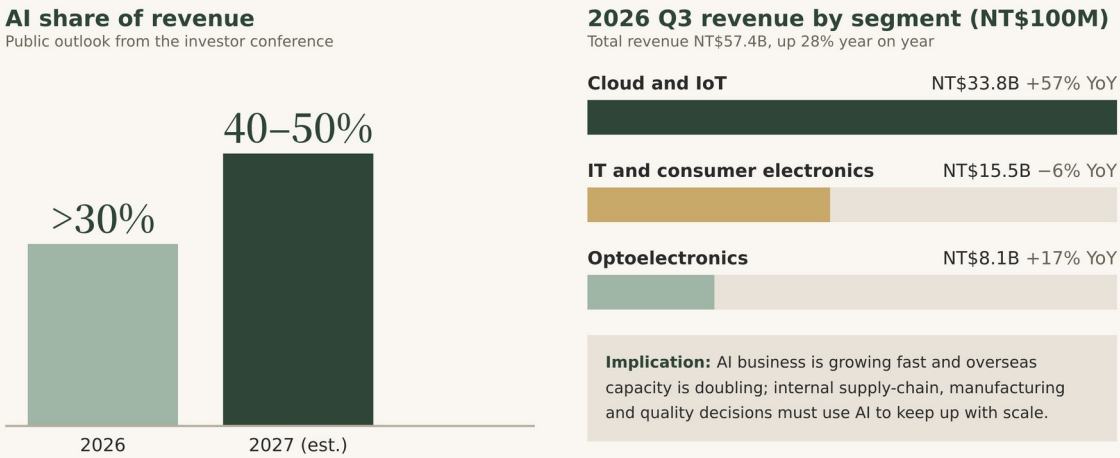


Figure 2 AI revenue share outlook and 2026 Q3 segment revenue

Area	Key public facts	What it means for the AI platform
Scale	86 subsidiaries, 112 plants, 20+ locations worldwide	Build once and replicate across plants; unify data definitions first
Capacity	Vietnam plant opened 2026.11; Kaohsiung Phase 2 in 2026.12; Texas, USA operating in 2027 Q2	New plants are the best AI pilots: no legacy baggage
Products	8.5kW PSU and BBU in volume production; 110kW Power Shelf, 800VDC Power Rack, 120kW CDU	Rising product complexity means R and D and quality knowledge need AI assistance
ERP	SAP ECC → S/4HANA, global go-live on 2027.01.04; 16 new functions and 27 process improvements	AI must extend outside the Clean Core to avoid re-customization
Manufacturing	MES tightly integrated with ERP: alternate parts, kit readiness, work-order scheduling	The next step is predict, recommend and decide proactively — exactly where agents fit

Sources: financial media feature report and LITEON's 2026 Q3 investor conference; figures per the official Market Observation Post System.

The problem behind the problem, and the mandate

Surface problem	Root cause	What the platform must do first
Line stops from shortages	Engineering changes (ECN) reach SAP and MES with a time lag	Turn ECNs into events and sync all three systems
Slow alternate-part decisions	Alternate-part approvals scattered across documents and emails	Build a structured alternate-part specification library
Distorted cross-plant comparison	Part numbers, lot numbers and yield defined differently by each plant	Unified definitions through data products
AI stuck at PoC	No PO, go-live criteria or P and L line	Productize use cases; a quarterly committee manages entry and exit

The mandate (summary of the job description)

Own LITEON's overall AI strategy and execution, moving AI from**single applications → products → a reusable platform**, delivering for the company**visible economic value**。

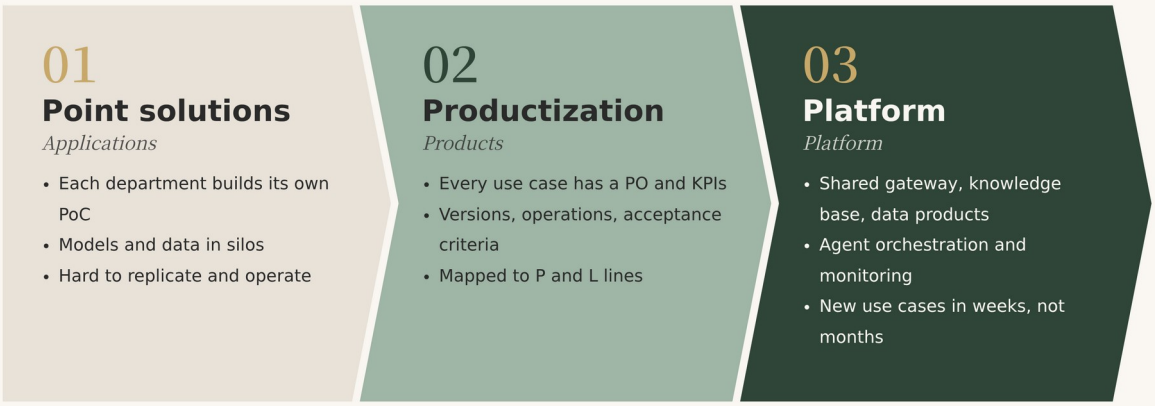


Figure 3 Three stages: the journey this role must complete

Competency fit



Figure 4 Technical and managerial competencies (●●● led and delivered)

Technical competencies	My track record and evidence
AI platform architecture (LLM gateway/RAG/Agent)	Three-tier enterprise AI platform: unified governance of multiple LLMs, multi-agent orchestration, human-in-the-loop; AI gateway + Agentic RAG + workflow engine
AI in production (manufacturing)	Hongyan Technology Edge AIoT platform covering 1,000+ machines; AI defect prediction and predictive maintenance: yield +15%, OEE +18%
AI in production (operations)	Sheng Xin / Sheng Qi Network Agentic AI workflows +55%; AI code review Lead Time −40%, defect escape −35%
Data platforms and data products	GameSparcs (6542) global data management platform; lakehouse Bronze/Silver/Gold layers and data contracts
SAP/PLM/MES integration	SAP S/4HANA connected with MES, PLM and APS; Clean Core custom objects −35%; Kafka/EDI/IDoc integration standards

Candidly

For large-model training and GPU cluster scheduling, my role is architecture decisions and resource governance, not hands-on tuning. After joining I will appoint a senior ML technical lead, while I focus on platform, data and value.

Managerial competencies and leadership style

Managerial competencies	My track record and evidence	Level
Defining priority AI domains	Reports directly to the Board; aligns with business goals through OGSM and led a 3-year application roadmap	●●●
Budget and investment governance	IT budgets from several million to ten million US dollars; CAPEX/OPEX allocation; multi-cloud TCO −30%	●●●
Building teams and pipelines	Teams of 100+ across Taiwan, China and Europe; built succession plans	●●●
Business leadership and PO development	AI workflow training for managers; three-stage enterprise AI adoption; Champions network	●●○
Cross-department change	Multi-plant consolidation, BPR process reengineering, ISO four-tier governance documents	●●●
Reporting to leadership	Quarterly reporting on yield, OEE, TCO and Lead Time; keynote speaker at industry conferences	●●●
External partners and SI management	SI contracts, SLAs, acceptance gates and vendor scorecards	●●●
Large-enterprise transformation	Group central IT architecture, multi-plant ERP, global platform migration	●●●

Leadership style

Principle	In practice
Go to the front line	Work alongside the business to break pain points into production-grade releases within weeks
Empower the front line	The platform team provides standards and components; business teams build their own use cases — IT is not the bottleneck
Keep knowledge in the team	SOPs, architecture decision records and knowledge bases reduce reliance on any one person
Talk in numbers	Every use case has a baseline, a target and an owner, reviewed openly each quarter

> **My leadership principle**: find the problem behind the problem before talking about models; data first, then AI; every use case must state which line of the P and L it will move.

Profile and education



Dr. Howard Liao Howard Liao, Ph.D.

Enterprise AI platform and digital transformation leader | VP of Technology / CIO / CISO

25+ years in IT and 15+ years as CIO and technology executive across electronics manufacturing, global software vendors and listed digital platforms. I turn board-level business goals into IT and AI investment portfolios, lead architecture decisions personally, and deliver results measured in yield, OEE and TCO. As an ISO 27001 and ISO 42001 Lead Auditor, I balance the speed of innovation with clear governance guardrails.

Education

Degree	School	Research focus
Ph.D. in IT Management (2014)	Chaoyang University of Technology	Dissertation: A study of an integrated business self-service portal based on adaptive service-oriented architecture IT governance (archived at the National Central Library)
M.S. in Information Science (2006)	National Chung Hsing University	Data mining, decision support systems, cryptography; co-principal investigator of a healthcare cloud care project

Research and publications

- First author, SCI journal Multimedia Tools and Applications: Reversible secret-image sharing with high visual quality (2014)
- International journal paper: Utilizing GIS and GPS in Designing a Trilingual Tourist APP (2015)
- Long-standing thesis supervisor and reviewer for master's and doctoral students

Professional certifications

Area	Certifications
Security and AI governance	ISO 27001 Lead Auditor, ISO 42001 (AIMS) Lead Auditor
Projects and agile	PMP, ScrumMaster, Agile Coach, ESG Sustainability Manager
Systems and supply chain	ERP supply chain/manufacturing module certification, database vendor certified instructor, international barcode management certification
Continuing development	CISSP/CISM, cloud architect (in preparation)

Career timeline

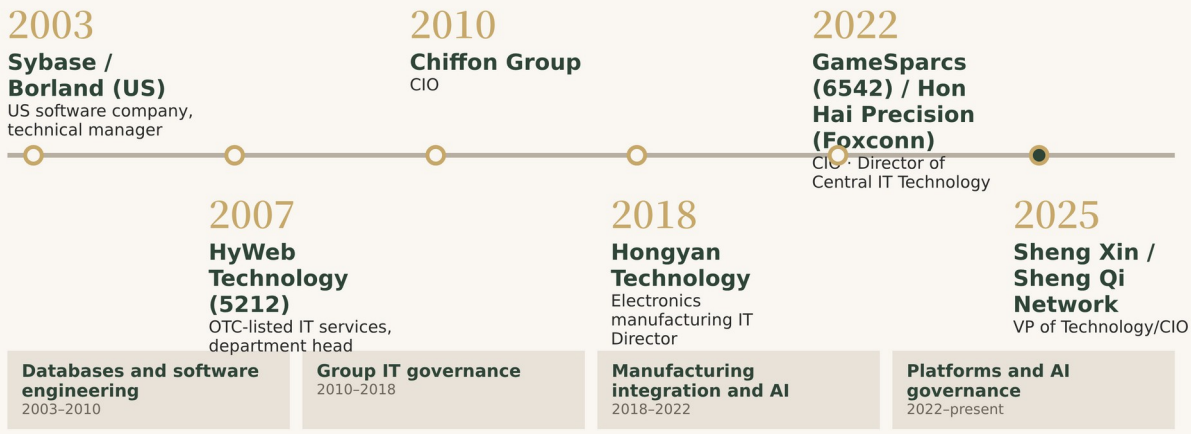


Figure 5 25+ years of evolution: software engineering → group governance → manufacturing AI → platforms and AI governance

Period	Company | Title	Key contributions	Results
2025.05 – present	Sheng Xin / Sheng Qi Network | VP of Technology/CIO	Chaired the architecture review board; API-first and Kafka/EDI/IDoc integration standards; DevSecOps quality gates; ISO 42001 AI governance; Agentic AI workflows	Agentic AI +55%
2026	Enterprise information architecture advisor (part-time)	Group IT strategy and investment plans, enterprise architecture blueprints, ERP and manufacturing systems integration blueprints, security governance plans	AI architecture blueprint
2022.09 – 2025.04	GameSparcs (6542) | Director of Information Technology (CIO/CISO)	Core services migrated to Kubernetes; global data management platform; FinOps; ISO 27001 and zero trust	TCO −30%, zero downtime
2022	Hon Hai Precision (Foxconn) | Director of Central IT Technology	Group enterprise architecture decisions, gap analysis and digital transformation planning	Enterprise architecture
2018.10 – 2022.09	Hongyan Technology | IT Director	Post-merger SAP S/4HANA consolidation connecting MES, PLM and APS; Edge AIoT; IEC 62443; B2B EDI	Yield +15%, OEE +18%
2010 – 2018	Chiffon Group | CIO	Group IT governance, systems integration and data teams	Data governance
2007 – 2010	HyWeb Technology (5212) | Department head	SOA architecture, business portal, ITIL service governance	—
2003 – 2007	Sybase / Borland (US) | Technical manager	Database, middleware and ALM technical consulting and delivery for Greater China	Database
Ongoing	Advisor to Taichung Veterans General Hospital; managing director of the Kang Shan Foundation	Healthcare data integration, smart long-term care and nonprofit digitalization	Healthcare data

External proof and years leading AI teams

Type	Content	Date
Vendor case study	Official APAC customer success video by a global cloud provider: container platform supporting global high concurrency with zero downtime	2024.03
Media interview	CIO magazine cover interview: using public cloud services to expand into global markets	2024.05
Technical feature	IT media feature: building a global data management platform	2024.09
Keynote	Keynote at a global database vendor conference in Taipei: a global-scale data management platform	2024.09
Keynote	CIO annual conference: seeing opportunity — cloud management in practice	2024.05
Public-sector course	Executive Yuan civil service e-learning platform course: cloud management in practice	2024.06

Years leading AI/data teams

Led data and systems teams as CIO since 2010; directly led AIoT and AI yield teams since 2018; led an Agentic AI team since 2025. More than 15 years in total, meeting the 10+ years requirement.

Fit with preferred requirements

Preferred requirements	My evidence
Built AI/data platforms and teams from scratch	Hongyan Technology Edge AIoT data hub and Sheng Xin / Sheng Qi Network AI governance and agent platform, both built from scratch
Communicating with the C-level and senior leadership	Reports directly to the Board and Global CIO; reports in EBITDA, TCO and ROIC
CIO or IT department head experience	15+ years as CIO/CISO/CDAIO/Director of IT
Digital transformation at large domestic enterprises	Multi-plant S/4HANA consolidation, zero-downtime migration of global core services, group central IT architecture

Case 1 | Manufacturing AI built on an integrated core

Situation	After the merger each plant ran independently with no capacity visibility, creating data silos and a large amount of slow-moving inventory.
Approach	SAP S/4HANA standard functions first (Clean Core), connected with MES, PLM and APS; Edge AIoT data platform covering 1,000+ machines, with AI defect prediction and predictive maintenance; Planned OT/IT segmentation per IEC 62443; built B2B EDI for brand customers
Results	+15% Yield, +18% OEE, −25% IT operating cost

+15%	+18%	−25%
Yield	**OEE**	**IT operating cost**

What it means for LITEON

AI extension after S/4HANA go-live, MES alternate-part and kit-readiness recommendations, replication template for new plants

Data first, then AI: a closed loop complementing SAP, PLM and MES

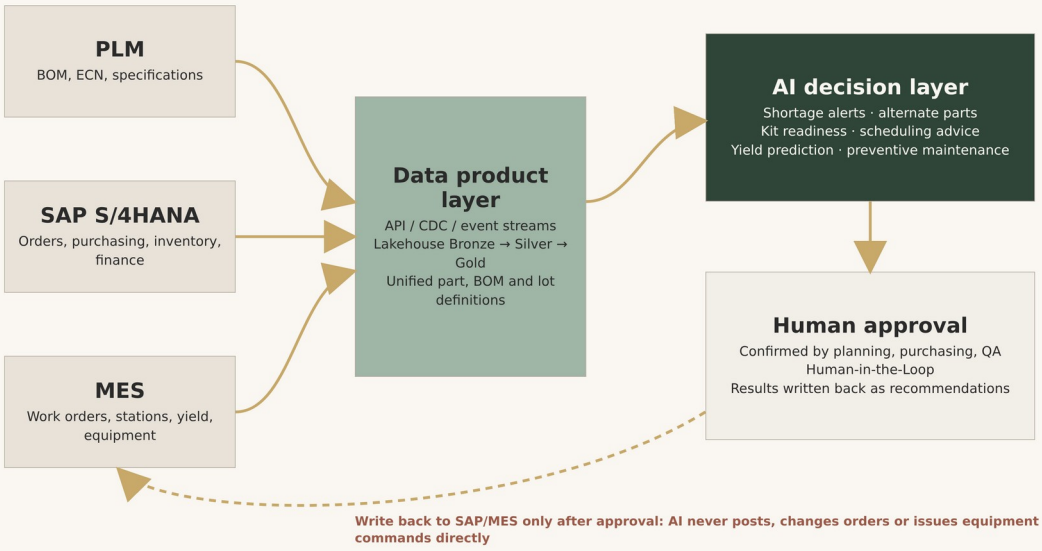


Figure 6 The case approach extended to LITEON: a closed loop complementing SAP, PLM and MES

Case 2 | Platform engineering with zero downtime

Situation	New products every month; the old database could not handle peak concurrency; each project built its own environment, creating a heavy operations burden.
Approach	Migrated core services to Kubernetes with CI/CD, halving the release cycle; Built a global data management platform with cross-region clusters; Introduced FinOps; established ISO 27001 and a zero-trust architecture
Results	Zero downtime Core services, −30% Multi-cloud TCO, ×2 Release speed

Zero downtime **Core services**	**−30%** **Multi-cloud TCO**	**×2** **Release speed**

What it means for LITEON

Move from departmental AI tools to a shared platform, running old and new in parallel with rollback

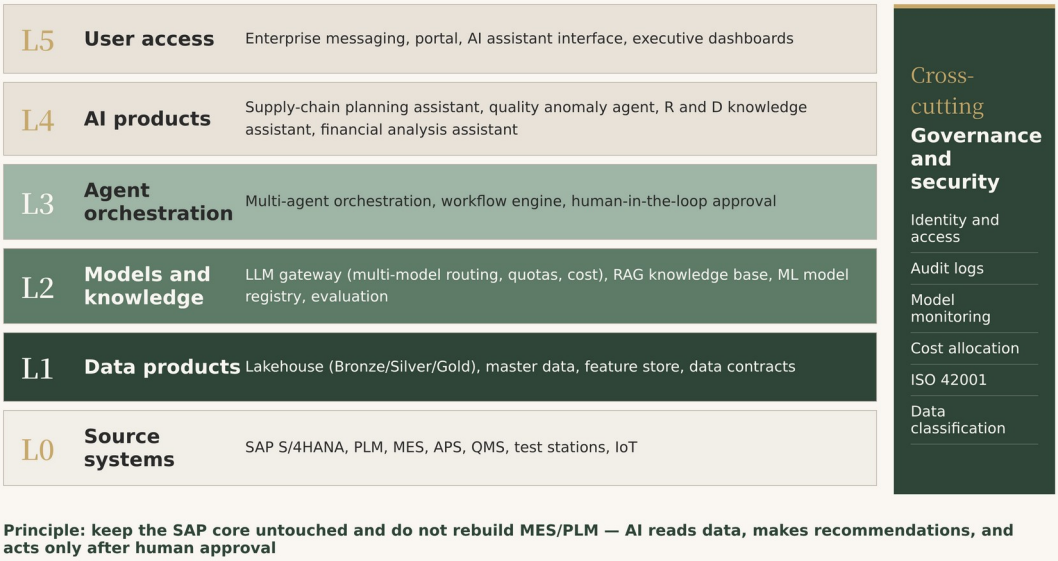


Figure 7 The platform approach extended to LITEON: AI platform layers

Case 3 | AI governance and agents in production

Situation	Fragmented multinational cloud assets and a shortage of security talent; employees using AI tools on their own created a high risk of data leakage.
Approach	Chaired the architecture review board and set API-first and integration standards; DevSecOps quality gates + AI code review and test generation; Set AI usage rules and data classification under ISO 42001; AI workflow training for managers; Agentic AI workflows with human-in-the-loop for high-risk actions
Results	+55% Automation efficiency, −40% Lead Time, −35% Defect escape

+55%	−40%	−35%
Automation efficiency	**Lead Time**	**Defect escape**

What it means for LITEON

A direct template for LITEON's AI usage rules, PO Academy and agent rollout

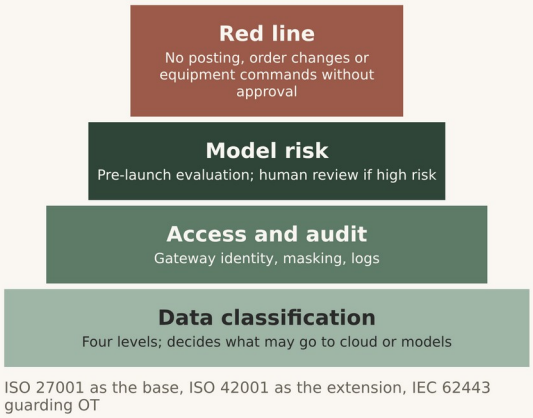


Figure 8 The governance approach extended to LITEON: AI governance and risk

Architecture work samples

The following are types of blueprints and architecture work recently written and built. For confidentiality, client names and project details are not disclosed; the methodology can be explained in person.

Work	Content	Relevance to the LITEON role
Group IT strategy blueprint	Annual IT operating plan: phased delivery with decision gates, WBS Gantt chart, IT investment and capital allocation	Group-level AI blueprint and the format for reporting to leadership
Enterprise AI architecture blueprint	Three pillars — application hub, multi-model gateway, prediction core; full enterprise architecture views	AI stack layering and model gateway design
Manufacturing systems integration blueprint	API platform + data lakehouse integrating PLM, SAP and MES, 90-day plan	A data foundation complementing SAP/PLM/MES
Security governance plan	NIST CSF 2.0, 180-day security hardening plan, behavior analytics monitoring	Security and incident response
Enterprise AI platform proposal	Three-tier architecture, multi-LLM governance, multi-agent orchestration, human-in-the-loop	AI platform architecture
Operational governance standardization program	Four-tier documents, ISMS/AI governance, RACI, 90-day timeline	Putting AI governance into practice and driving the organization
Zero-to-one organization turnaround report	Nine stages, pain points of three teams, and tools	Building teams from zero
White papers from frontier technology seminars	AI agents, inference architecture, enterprise sovereign AI	Trend assessment and executive communication

Howa

LITEON AI platform blueprint

Design principle: **Keep the SAP core untouched; do not rebuild MES/PLM**. The AI platform sits beside the three core systems, reading data, making recommendations and acting within authorized limits.

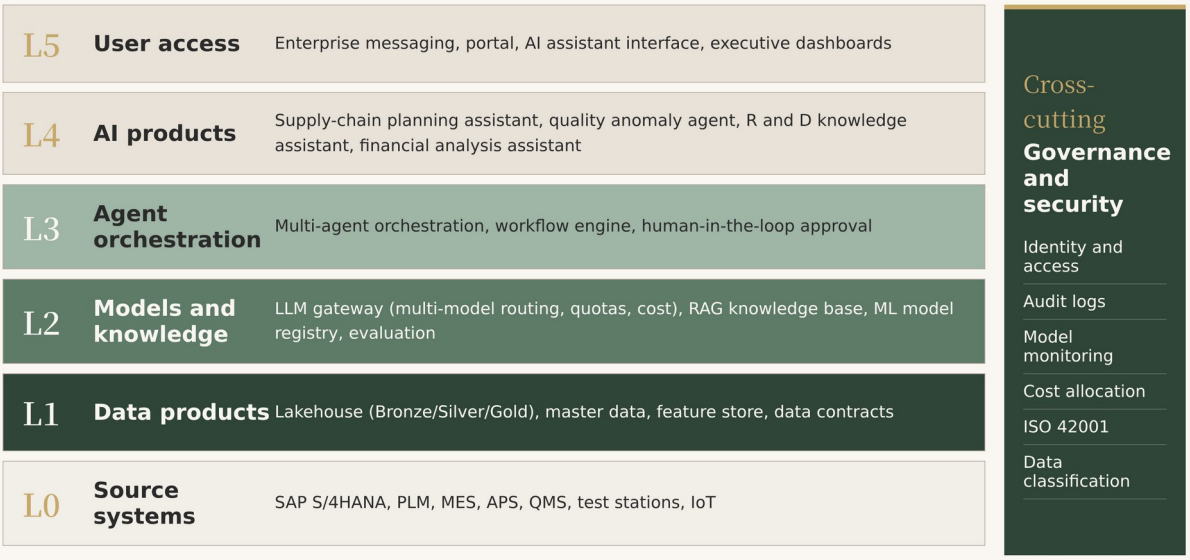


Figure 9 LITEON AI platform: L0–L5 with cross-cutting governance

System	Their role: records and transactions	AI platform role: prediction and recommendation
SAP S/4HANA	Orders, purchasing, inventory, financial postings	Demand forecasting, shortage alerts, anomalous transaction detection, month-end analysis
PLM	BOM, ECN, drawing versions	Design knowledge search, alternate-part recommendations, ECN impact analysis
MES	Work-order execution, station records, traceability	Scheduling optimization recommendations, yield prediction, preventive equipment maintenance

Data first, then AI

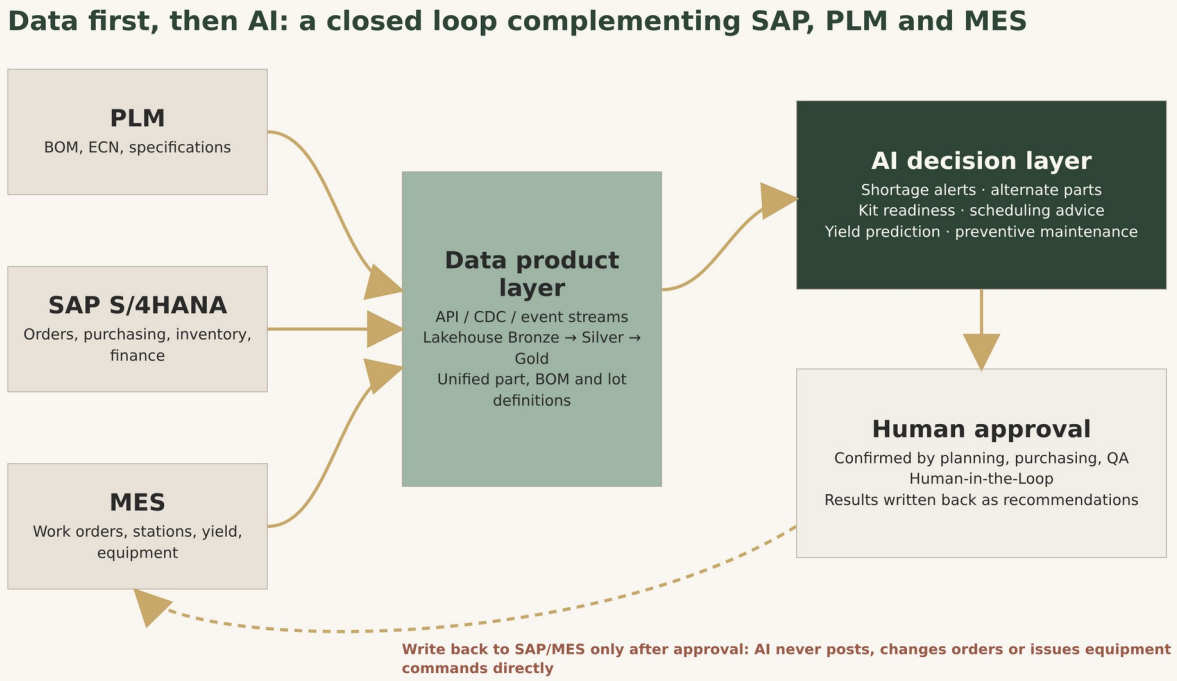


Figure 10 The data and decision loop complementing SAP, PLM and MES

Three platform routes

Route	Strengths	Watch-outs
SAP-native	Deepest integration with S/4HANA	Less flexibility in model choice and cost
Public cloud AI services	Wide model choice, fast scaling	Data residency and usage cost
Open-source on-prem	Data stays on site, cost is controllable	Requires in-house operations capability

Approved after comparing TCO and data sovereignty, with no single vendor assumed.

Priority AI domains and use-case portfolio

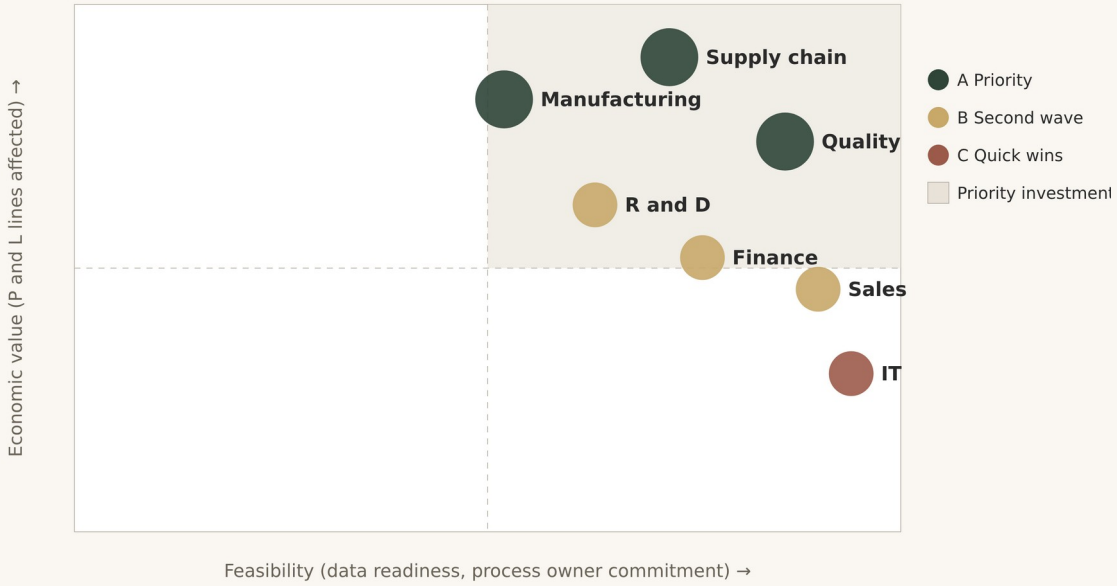


Figure 11 Economic value × feasibility; Grade A is the year-one priority

Area	Representative use cases	P and L lines affected	Priority
Supply chain	Shortage alerts, kit-readiness and alternate-part recommendations, demand forecasting	Inventory, line-stop losses from shortages	A
Manufacturing	Work-order scheduling recommendations, yield prediction, preventive equipment maintenance	Capacity utilization, scrap	A
Quality	Failure analysis knowledge assistant, automatic 8D summaries for customer complaints	Cost of quality, complaint cycle time	A
R and D	Specification and standards search, design review assistant, test report analysis	R and D cycle time	B
Finance	Month-end anomaly analysis, cross-currency forecasting, audit sampling	Labor cost, decision speed	B
Sales	RFQ and quotation analysis, contract clause comparison	Quotation cycle time, gross margin	B
IT	AI code review, test generation, service desk agent	IT cost, delivery speed	C

AI organization, talent pipeline and PO Academy

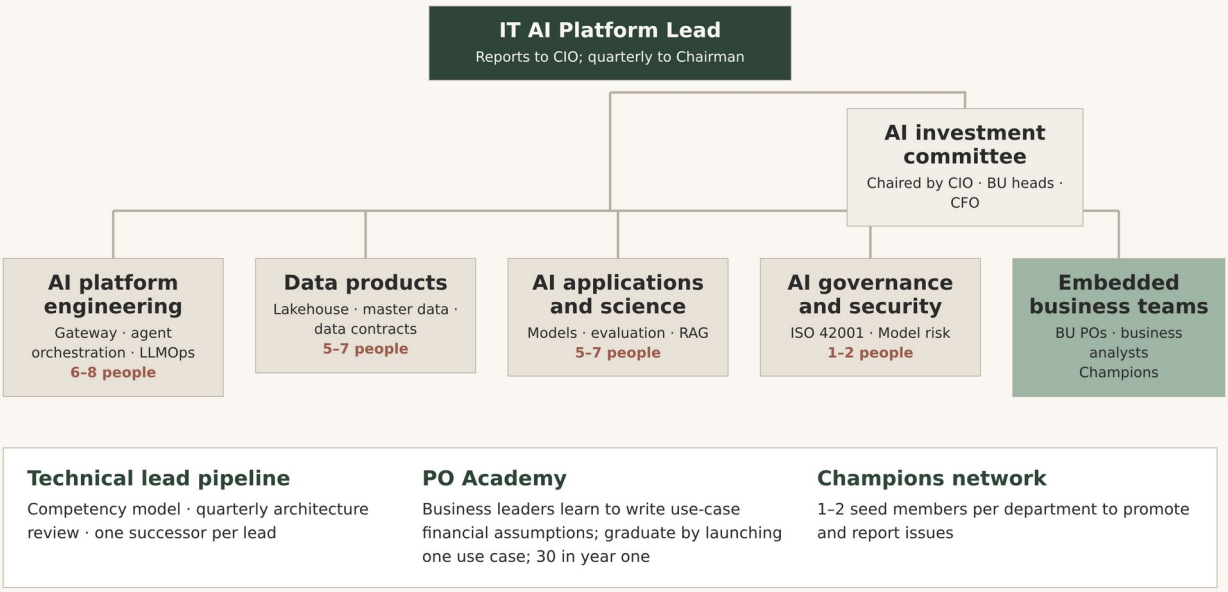


Figure 12 Dual-track organization: central platform + embedded business teams

Team	Responsibilities	Year-one headcount
AI platform engineering	Model gateway, agent orchestration, MLOps/LLMOps, monitoring	6–8
Data products	Lakehouse, master data, feature store, data contracts	5–7
AI applications and science	Model development, evaluation, RAG tuning	5–7
AI governance and security	ISO 42001, model risk, data classification	1–2
Embedded business teams	Use-case delivery, process redesign	Staffed by the BU

Three stages of AI-native work

- **L1 Literacy and personal use**: AI usage rules, data classification, AI workflow training for managers.
- **L2 Department processes and agents**: each department picks 1–2 processes, with the business as PO and IT providing the platform.
- **L3 Cross-department redesign and scale-out**: cross-department agent integration, shared knowledge base, Champions network.

Governance and the first 180 days

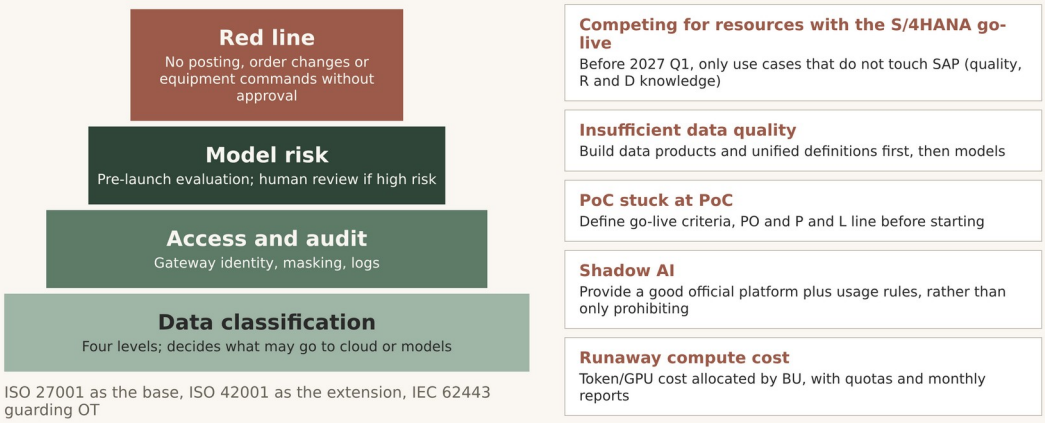


Figure 13 ISO 27001 as the base, ISO 42001 as the extension, IEC 62443 guarding OT

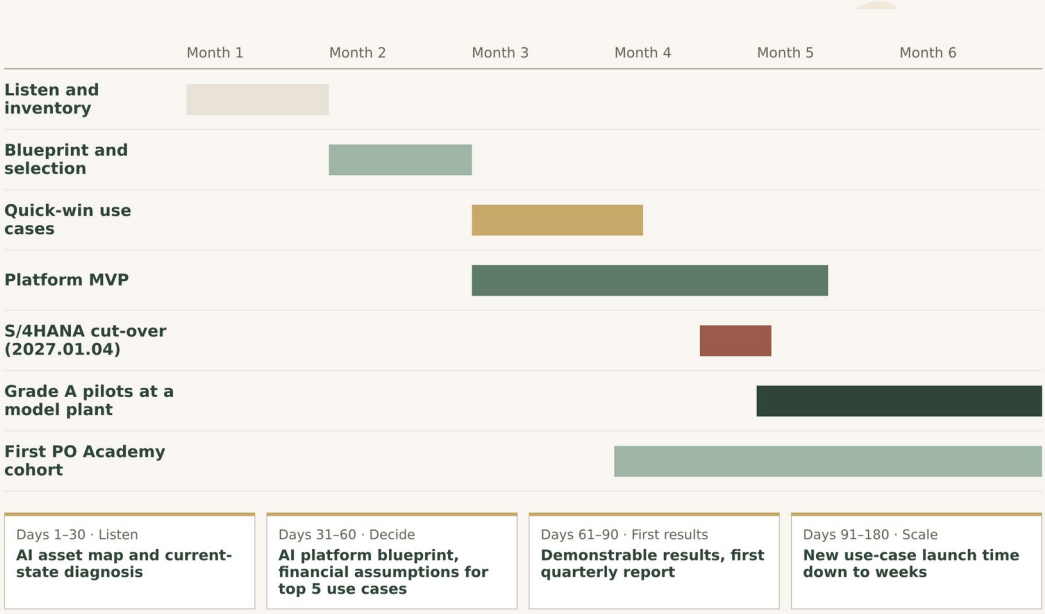


Figure 14 First 180 days: aligned with the S/4HANA cut-over on 2027.01.04

Year-one KPIs, expected questions and closing

Category	Metric	Direction
Economic value	Verified annualized benefit (confirmed by the CFO)	Targets agreed within 60 days of joining
Platform	Number of live use cases; time to launch a new use case	≥ 10; ≤ 4 weeks
Adoption	Monthly active users of the AI platform as a share of employees	Rising every quarter
Organization	Certified POs; successors for technical leads	30; one per lead
Governance	Use-case risk assessment completion rate; major security incidents	100%; zero
Cost	Cost per thousand requests; compute budget attainment	Down every quarter; ±10%

Expected questions

Question	Key points of my answer
How do the AI platform and the S/4HANA go-live avoid interfering with each other?	Before 2027 Q1, only use cases that do not touch SAP; the platform reads via APIs with no core customization; supply-chain use cases follow once the go-live is stable.
How do you keep PoCs from dragging on?	Define the PO, go-live criteria and P and L line before starting; the quarterly committee retires use cases without value.
How much value can AI create for LITEON?	Start with three P and L lines — inventory, yield and cost of quality — and present an estimate confirmed by the CFO within 90 days.
What will LITEON's AI look like in three years?	Every business group has its own AI products; new plants have predictive capability from day one; employees use AI as an everyday tool.
Why you?	Has done manufacturing SAP/MES integration, platform engineering and AI governance — and can write the architecture personally; speaks in business metrics.

Closing

The best technology leader translates the language of technology into the language of business and risk. I want to help LITEON move AI from point solutions to a reusable platform, so that every dollar invested shows a visible return.

Contact: +886-975-323161 · Liao.Howard@gmail.com